

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

*PROJECT NEXUS 2026:
AI INNOVATION CHALLENGE*



Organised By:

IEEE MMU SB 2026

Institute of Electrical & Electronics Engineers
Multimedia University Student Branch
2026



Multimedia University (Cyberjaya Campus)
Persiaran Multimedia, 63100 Cyberjaya, Selangor

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1. Eligibility

1.1. Who May Participate

Participation is open to pre-university, undergraduate, and postgraduate students currently enrolled in Engineering, Artificial Intelligence, Computer Science, or a related technical field at any Malaysian higher education institution.

1.2. Team Composition

1. Each team must have a minimum of 2 and a maximum of 4 members.
2. All team members must be students at a Malaysian higher education institution at the time of registration.
3. A student may only register with one team for the duration of the competition.
4. Teams may include members from different universities or faculties.

1.3. Women in Engineering (WIE) Requirement

MANDATORY — WIE Membership

Every participating team must include at least one (1) female member. Teams that do not satisfy this requirement will **not be accepted into the competition** regardless of other merits, and remain liable to disqualification if discovered after acceptance.

Teams with at least 50% female representation or a female-designated Team Lead will receive bonus Diversity Credits applied during Phase 1 scoring.

Teams meeting the 50% threshold will have exclusive access to mentors who are women leaders in engineering and innovation.

The eligible female participant with the highest overall performance may receive the “Nexus 2026: Woman Innovator of the Year” individual award.

1.4. Registration Fees

Registration fees are charged per team and are **non-refundable** once a submission has been successfully made through the official registration portal.

Team Category	Registration Fee (RM)
Teams with 50% of members holding student membership of an organising society (IEEE MMU, IEM MMU, UTP E3S2, EWB MMU)	RM 20
Teams consisting entirely of MMU students	RM 30
All other teams	RM 40

2. Competition Tracks

Each team must select exactly one competition track (Healthcare Technology, Sustainable Solutions, or Global Impact) during registration. Track changes are not permitted after the Phase 1 submission deadline (26 July 2026). Full track descriptions are provided in the Official Handbook, Section 2.

3. Mandatory Compliance Obligation

By participating, teams accept the following mandatory obligations as binding conditions of continued participation:

3.1. Submission Deadlines

Teams must meet the Phase 1 proposal submission deadline (26 July 2026) and the final submission deadline (16 September 2026, 23:59 MYT). Incomplete Phase 1 submissions will not be evaluated, and late final submissions will not be evaluated under any circumstances.

3.2. Seed Grant Financial Compliance

MANDATORY — Seed Grant Financial Compliance

The RM 700 prototype seed grant must be used exclusively for purchasing hardware components required to build the solution prototype. Receipts for all purchases must be submitted in a separate PDF together with the updated proposal. Any leftover funds must be transferred back to the Treasurer of Project Nexus 2026, and leftover amounts must align precisely with the receipts submitted. Purchases not directly related to building the prototype will result in **team disqualification** and **blacklisting** from future IEEE MMU SB competitions.

3.3. Physical Prototype Requirement

MANDATORY — Physical Prototype Requirement

Every team that advances to the Grand Finale must deliver a physical, functioning hardware prototype. Software-only or purely conceptual submissions **will not be accepted at the Grand Finale stage**, and prototypes must perform their core function live during the booth demonstration.

3.4. Grand Finale Attendance

Attendance in person at the Grand Finale (Multimedia University, Cyberjaya Campus) is mandatory for all members of the 15 finalist teams. Remote participation is not permitted under any circumstances. Teams that fail to appear without prior written notice to the General Chair will be disqualified and forfeit all associated prizes. The prototype demonstrated must be the same prototype submitted in the Phase 3 final submission; substitutions or significant post-submission modifications require prior written approval from the Technical Division Chair.

4. AI Usage Rule

All finalist teams are required to meaningfully integrate the provided AI tools into their prototype development workflow. Using AI solely for generating documentation, reports, or presentation slides is insufficient. Teams must demonstrate AI integration at the level of prototype design and system architecture decisions, software or firmware algorithm development, and simulation, testing, or debugging of the prototype.

✓ Permitted	✗ Prohibited
Using AI to assist with code generation and debugging	Sharing AI access credentials with non-participants
Using AI to simulate hardware or system behaviour	Using AI access for work unrelated to Project Nexus
Using AI to assist with schematic or algorithm design	Attempting to circumvent the sandbox environment
Identifying and correcting AI errors as part of the workflow	Presenting AI-generated output as entirely original work without acknowledgment in the Nexus Log

4.1. The Nexus Log — Mandatory Documentation

Every team must maintain and submit a “Nexus Log” as part of their final submission, demonstrating active and critical engagement with AI tools. It must include:

1. A detailed breakdown of how AI was used to coordinate project workflow and key design decisions.
2. Specific instances where the team identified AI errors or limitations, and how these were manually corrected or overridden.
3. A brief comparative analysis of how the AI-assisted final prototype outperformed or differed from the team’s original concept.

Failure to submit a complete Nexus Log may result in **disqualification** from individual awards and a reduced score in the final judging stage.

5. Conduct and Integrity

5.1. Original Work

All submitted work must be original and created specifically for Project Nexus 2026 during the competition period. The following are strictly prohibited: submitting work previously developed for coursework, a thesis, or another competition; plagiarism of code, schematics, designs, or written content from any source; and presenting another team's work as one's own. Violations will result in **immediate disqualification**, and serious cases may be referred to the participant's institution for academic integrity proceedings.

5.2. Respectful Conduct

All participants, mentors, judges, committee members, and guests are expected to engage respectfully and professionally throughout the competition. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, or unsportsmanlike conduct of any kind will not be tolerated. The Organising Committee reserves the right to remove any individual or team from the competition for conduct violations.

5.3. Confidentiality of Judging Criteria

Phase 1 scoring criteria are published in the Official Handbook. Grand Finale judging rubrics are withheld until finalists are briefed prior to the event. Participants must not attempt to obtain or share non-public judging information.

5.4. Intellectual Property and Publicity

Teams retain full ownership of their ideas, designs, and prototypes. By participating in Project Nexus 2026, each team grants IEEE MMU SB a non-exclusive, royalty-free licence to feature project materials (photographs, video demonstrations, project descriptions) in competition-related publicity and reports, with appropriate attribution to the team.

6. Disqualification

A team or individual may be disqualified from Project Nexus 2026 for any of the following reasons. Disqualification decisions are made by the Organising Committee and are final.

6.1. Grounds for Team Disqualification

1. Failure to include at least one female member in the team (WIE requirement).
2. Missing the Phase 1 submission deadline (26 July 2026) or the final submission deadline (16 September 2026).
3. Submitting a prototype that does not function as described during the Grand Finale live demonstration.
4. Misuse of the AI sandbox access (e.g., credential sharing, off-project use).
5. Misappropriation of the prototype seed grant funds.
6. Plagiarism, academic dishonesty, or submission of previously developed work.
7. Failure to appear at the Grand Finale without prior written notice to the General Chair.
8. Any conduct deemed unacceptable by the Organising Committee under the Conduct & Integrity provisions.

6.2. Grounds for Individual Disqualification

1. Harassment or discriminatory conduct directed at any person associated with the competition.
2. Failure to submit the Nexus Log (may result in exclusion from individual awards only).
3. Any attempt to impersonate another participant or committee member.

7. General Provisions

7.1. Finality of Decisions

All decisions by the Organising Committee, Technical Division, and judging panel regarding scores, team selections, track assignments, and awards are final and binding. Written appeals regarding procedural matters (not scoring outcomes) may be submitted to the General Chair within 48 hours of the relevant decision. Appeals regarding subjective judging outcomes will not be entertained.

7.2. Rule Amendments

IEEE MMU SB reserves the right to amend, clarify, or supplement these Terms & Conditions and the rules in the Official Handbook at any time during the competition period. All registered participants will be notified of material changes via the official communication channels (email and the competition's social media platforms). Continued participation after notification of a rule change constitutes acceptance of the updated rules.

7.3. Force Majeure

IEEE MMU SB shall not be held liable for any failure to perform or delay in performing obligations under these Terms & Conditions arising from circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to natural disasters, public health emergencies, government directives, or venue unavailability. In such events, the committee will communicate revised arrangements to participants as soon as practicable.

7.4. Acceptance of Terms

Registration of a team and/or submission of any proposal, video, or prototype to Project Nexus 2026 constitutes acknowledgement that all team members have read, understood, and agree to be bound by these Terms & Conditions and the rules set out in the Official Handbook in full.

8. Contact Information

For any enquiries regarding these Terms & Conditions or the competition in general, please contact:

Role	Contact Details
Director	Izzat Nazarudin MUHAMMAD.IZZAT.MUHAMMAD1@STUDENT.MMU.EDU.MY +60 11-65452811 https://www.linkedin.com/in/muhammad-izzat-nazarudin/
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By registering for and/or participating in Project Nexus 2026, all team members agree to be bound by the following Terms & Conditions. These Terms & Conditions summarise the binding obligations, restrictions, and consequences applicable to all participants.

Project Nexus 2026: AI Innovation Challenge

IEEE Multimedia University Student Branch